QUICK GUIDE

KICK DRUM WAVEFORM

What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

A kick drum is a short, heavy, low-frequency hit. On a waveform it shows as a tall peak at the start of the beat that dies away quickly.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Deep and punchy. You feel it in your chest.



01

TALL PEAK, FAST FADE

A big hit on the beat, then it decays.

02

DEEP LOW END

Most kick energy sits roughly between 40 and 100 Hz.

03

STEADY IN HOUSE AND TECHNO

One kick on every beat. Four on the floor.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Cut the low end on the incoming track. Swap bass on the bar line.

- [ ] Cut the low EQ on the track you're bringing in.
- [ ] Line the kicks up on the grid.
- [ ] Swap the bass on a bar line, never mid-bar.



PRACTICE & CHECK

KICK DRUM WAVEFORM: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Four on the floor: one kick on every beat in house and techno.
- Matching kick to kick when you beatmatch.
- Bass swaps: cutting one kick's low end as the next one comes in.

QUICK CHECK

1. What does a kick look like?

2. Where does most kick energy sit?

3. What do you cut when bringing a new track in?

Answer key: 1) A tall peak that fades fast. 2) Roughly 40 to 100 Hz. 3) The low EQ.

REMEMBER

Two kicks at once means mud. One kick at a time.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Snare & Hi-Hat Waveform

